

risk, but markets grow and recover from dips over time. This is another thing that you might like to discuss with a financial advisor, but it's very easy to get started with a small amount each month.

Once I finished paying off my debt, creating financial security for my family was next on the priority list. This included saving hard for a house deposit, but I was also delighted to be able to open JISAs for both of my children, and put something small away for them each month. I check to see how they're doing every now and then, and it gives me a little burst of financial joy to know that I'm succeeding in that.

Making decisions about credit and debt

As someone whose whole career and platform was catalysed by a huge sum of personal debt and a mission to pay it off, it often surprises people that I don't take a more hard-line approach when it comes to people using credit or taking on debt. There's rarely space for much nuance in online conversations, and I've already discussed the fact that our cultural understanding of money is famously missing any nuance, so maybe it's no surprise that I'm assumed by some to be the face of the anti-debt movement. As with everything else in personal finance, your decision to use credit or take on debt is entirely personal to you. I sometimes worry that the discourse around encouraging people to take using credit seriously, and making sure that debt can be serviced without causing damage to